



APRIL 2026 GENERAL CONFERENCE

Come Home

Elder Clark G. Gilbert asked us to help people
find their way home. Here's how we do that.

Elk Ridge 7th Ward • Elders Quorum

“

President Oaks declared that the journey home starts by *reanchoring on the Savior*. Only Jesus Christ can *fully* restore that light and joy into your life. We all struggle. We need patience, service, and love from others.



ONE QUESTION, BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE

He says we need patience,
service, and love
from others.

Who are the others?

He never says. Today I want to argue that he means us.

WHERE WE'RE GOING

Christ is calling — and He calls through people.

- **The talk** — what Elder Gilbert actually said Josh
- **The gift, not the program** — why we lead with Christ Josh
- **Hunter's story** — what love and acceptance can do Hunter
- **The ward mission plan** — and leading with the Spirit Jeff

A man with glasses, wearing a dark suit, white shirt, and patterned tie, is speaking at a wooden podium. Behind him is a large arrangement of white and purple flowers. The image is dimly lit, with the speaker and the podium being the primary light sources.

01

What Elder Gilbert actually said

His first address since being ordained to the
Quorum of the Twelve, February 2026.

HE CHOSE TWO NAMES TO WITNESS OF

Redeemer

He buys us back. The price is already paid.

Repairer

“When we fall short, He repairs the breaches in our lives.”

A builder's word, not a rescue word. Something broken is being rebuilt — not merely retrieved.

“COME HOME,” ¶13



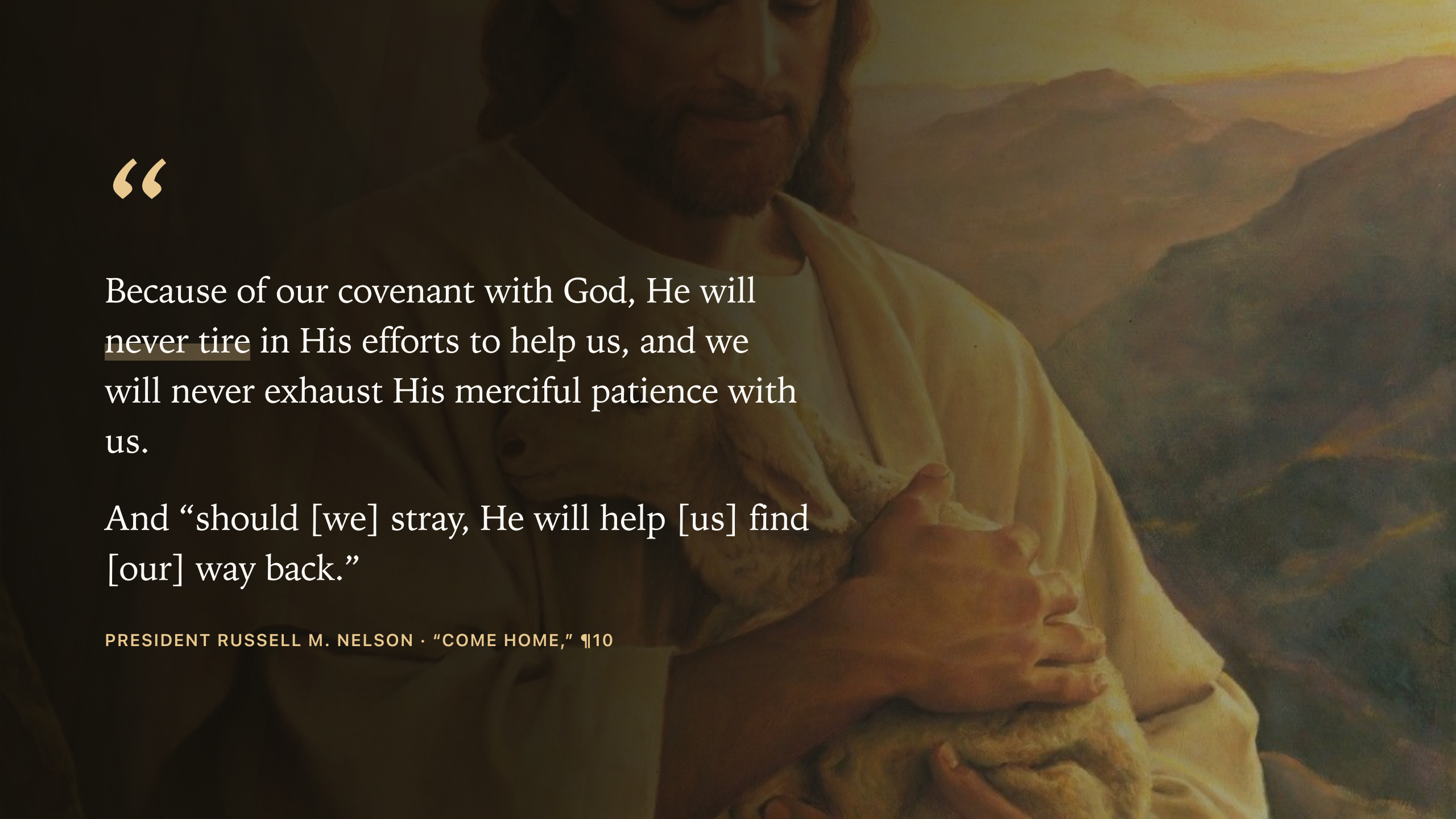


WHERE THE NAME COMES FROM

ISAIAH 58:12

¹² And they that shall be of thee shall build the old waste places: thou shalt raise up the foundations of many generations; and thou shalt be called, The repairer of the breach,
The restorer of paths to dwell in.

Read it aloud. Notice the verbs: *build, raise up, restore*. And notice who does the building — “they that shall be of thee.”



“

Because of our covenant with God, He will never tire in His efforts to help us, and we will never exhaust His merciful patience with us.

And “should [we] stray, He will help [us] find [our] way back.”

PRESIDENT RUSSELL M. NELSON • “COME HOME,” ¶10

ELDER GILBERT NAMED FOUR REASONS PEOPLE DON'T COME HOME

And he gave a real person for every one of them.

“I don't belong.”

Tammy — out of the Church 30 years

“I don't measure up.”

Luis — didn't think he was worthy of baptism

“I have doubts.”

Justin & Kenna — moved away to leave the faith

“My traditions won't let me.”

John — held back by his late parents' faith

BARRIER ONE

“I don't belong here anymore.”

Tammy had been away thirty years. What moved her was a temple open house and a bishop who kept encouraging her. She later received her endowment.

Worth noticing: she was welcomed *before* she was all the way back. Belonging came first. It was not the reward for returning — it was the road.



BARRIER TWO

“I don't measure up.”

You don't have to be perfect to be in this Church. You just have to do your best, and Christ will make up the difference.

ELDER GILBERT, TO LUIS — ON THE STEPS OF THE SAN ANTONIO TEMPLE

He was baptized a month later. His family was sealed in that same temple.





BARRIER THREE

“I have doubts.”

Justin and Kenna moved away specifically to leave the faith behind. The door reopened because their eight-year-old son wanted to be baptized.

Elder Gilbert's counsel was not to resolve every doubt. It was to *anchor in what they still believed* and let the Lord work on the rest. They were sealed as a family.

BARRIER FOUR

“My traditions won't let me.”

John, a former BYU football player, turned it down out of loyalty to his deceased parents' faith.

He joined once he realized his parents would have supported him. The obstacle was never doctrine. It was love pointed the wrong direction — and it took someone patient enough to stay near while he worked it out.



LOOK AT THAT LIST AGAIN

Four barriers. Not one of them is
“they don't know the Church is
true.”

Every barrier he named is a *feeling* — unwelcome, unworthy, unsure, unfree.

Information does not move any of those.
Relationship does.



THE THING ALL FOUR STORIES SHARE

There was always a person
there.

A bishop. A missionary. An eight-year-old boy. A
teammate.

Nobody in that talk came home alone.



02

The gift, not the program

Why we lead with Christ and His Atonement —
and not with the ward.

THE HINGE OF THIS WHOLE DISCUSSION

Elder Gilbert says only one thing *fully* restores light and joy.

It isn't the ward. It isn't the activities, the standards, or the community. Those are good — but they are not the gift.

So our invitations should sound like the gift.

TWO WAYS TO INVITE THE SAME PERSON

One asks them to join. One offers them relief.

INVITING TO THE INSTITUTION

“Come to church with us.”

“We have a really great ward.”

“There's an activity Thursday.”

INVITING TO THE GIFT

“There's something that carried me through the worst year of my life.”

“You don't have to be fixed first.”

“I know Someone who knows exactly what this feels like.”

Neither column is dishonest. But only one of them answers the four barriers Elder Gilbert just named.



1 NEPHI 8:11–12

11 And it came to pass that I did go forth and partake of the fruit thereof; and I beheld that it was most sweet, above all that I ever before tasted. Yea, and I beheld that the fruit thereof was white, to exceed all the whiteness that I had ever seen.

12 And as I partook of the fruit thereof it filled my soul with exceedingly great joy; wherefore, I began to be desirous that my family should partake of it also; for I knew that it was desirable above all other fruit.

Lehi tastes it — and his very next breath is wanting his family to have it. Missionary work is the reflex of someone who has tasted.



WHY WE GO

ALMA 26:12

¹² Yea, I know that I am nothing; as to my strength I am weak; therefore I will not boast of myself, but I will boast of my God, for in his strength I can do all things; yea, behold, many mighty miracles we have wrought in this land, for which we will praise his name forever.

ALMA 29:9

⁹ I know that which the Lord hath commanded me, and I glory in it. I do not glory of myself, but I glory in that which the Lord hath commanded me; yea, and this is my glory, that perhaps I may be an instrument

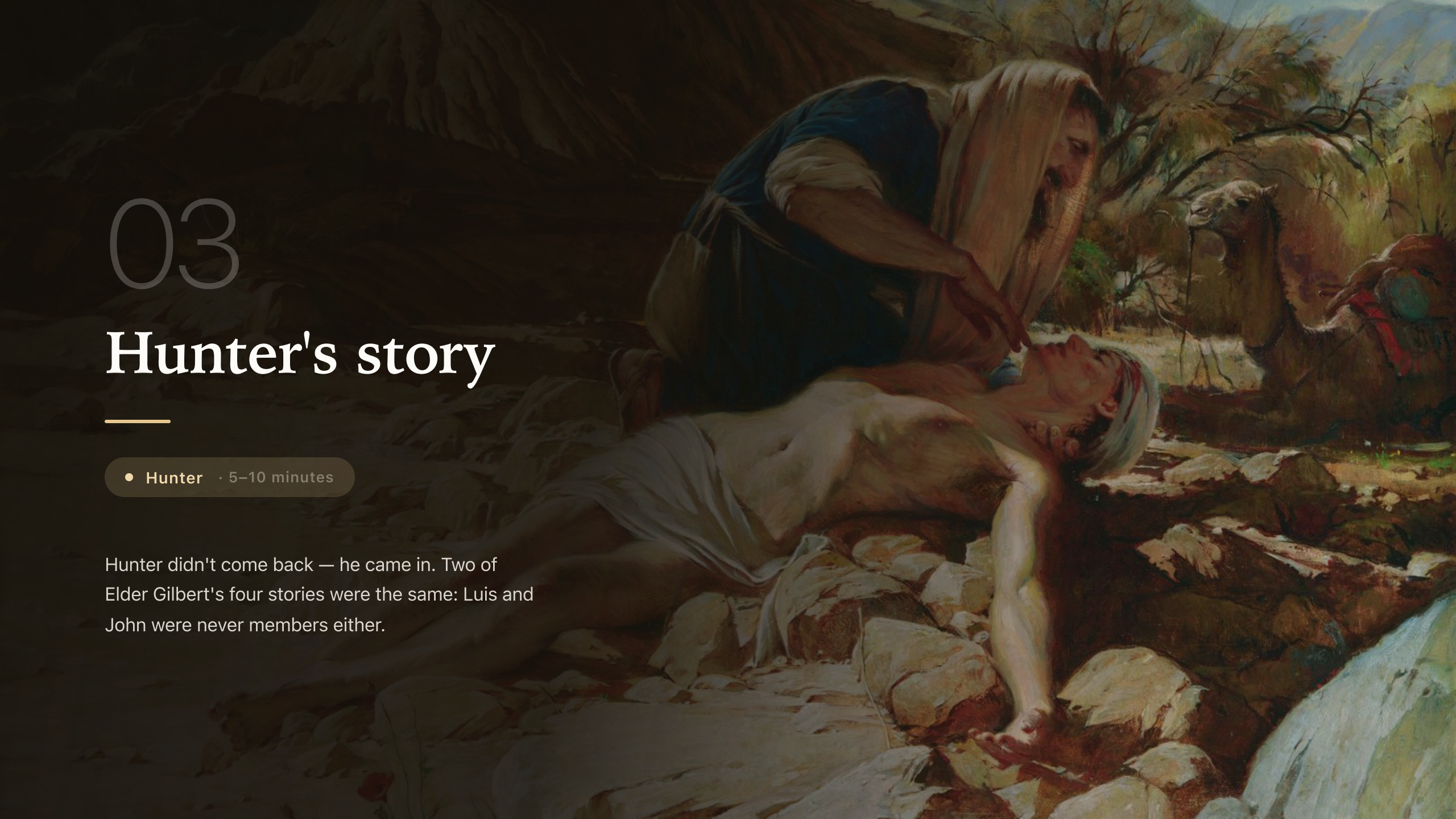
AND NOTICE WHAT HE PROMISES IN RETURN

DOCTRINE AND COVENANTS 18:10, 15–16

- ¹⁰ Remember the worth of souls is great in the sight of God;
- ¹⁵ And if it so be that you should labor all your days in crying repentance unto this people, and bring, save it be one soul unto me, how great shall be your joy with him in the kingdom of my Father!
- ¹⁶ And now, if your joy will be great with one soul that you have brought unto me into the kingdom of my Father, how great will be your joy if you should bring many souls unto me!

Same word Elder Gilbert used. The *joy* Christ restores to them turns out to be the same joy He gives to whoever went and got them.



A painting depicting a scene of care in a rugged, mountainous landscape. A woman, wearing a blue tunic and a light-colored headscarf, is leaning over a man who is lying on his back on the ground. She appears to be tending to his head or neck. The man is shirtless, wearing a white loincloth, and has a white headscarf. The ground is rocky and uneven. In the background, there are mountains and some sparse vegetation. A camel is visible in the distance, partially obscured by the woman's figure. The overall tone is somber and dramatic.

03

Hunter's story

- Hunter · 5–10 minutes

Hunter didn't come back — he came in. Two of Elder Gilbert's four stories were the same: Luis and John were never members either.

EVERYTHING WE'VE SAID SO FAR, IN ONE LIFE

What Hunter will walk us through

1 What it's actually like out there.

Living outside Utah — and outside the Church — pulls on you in ways most of this room has never had to feel. The drinking. The drugs. The drift.

2 Where that road goes.

At a minimum, someone who is lost. At worst, someone who doesn't make it out at all.

3 What it takes to get out.

Seeing the damage clearly — and people who accept you before you've changed anything.

4 What you can see from the other side.

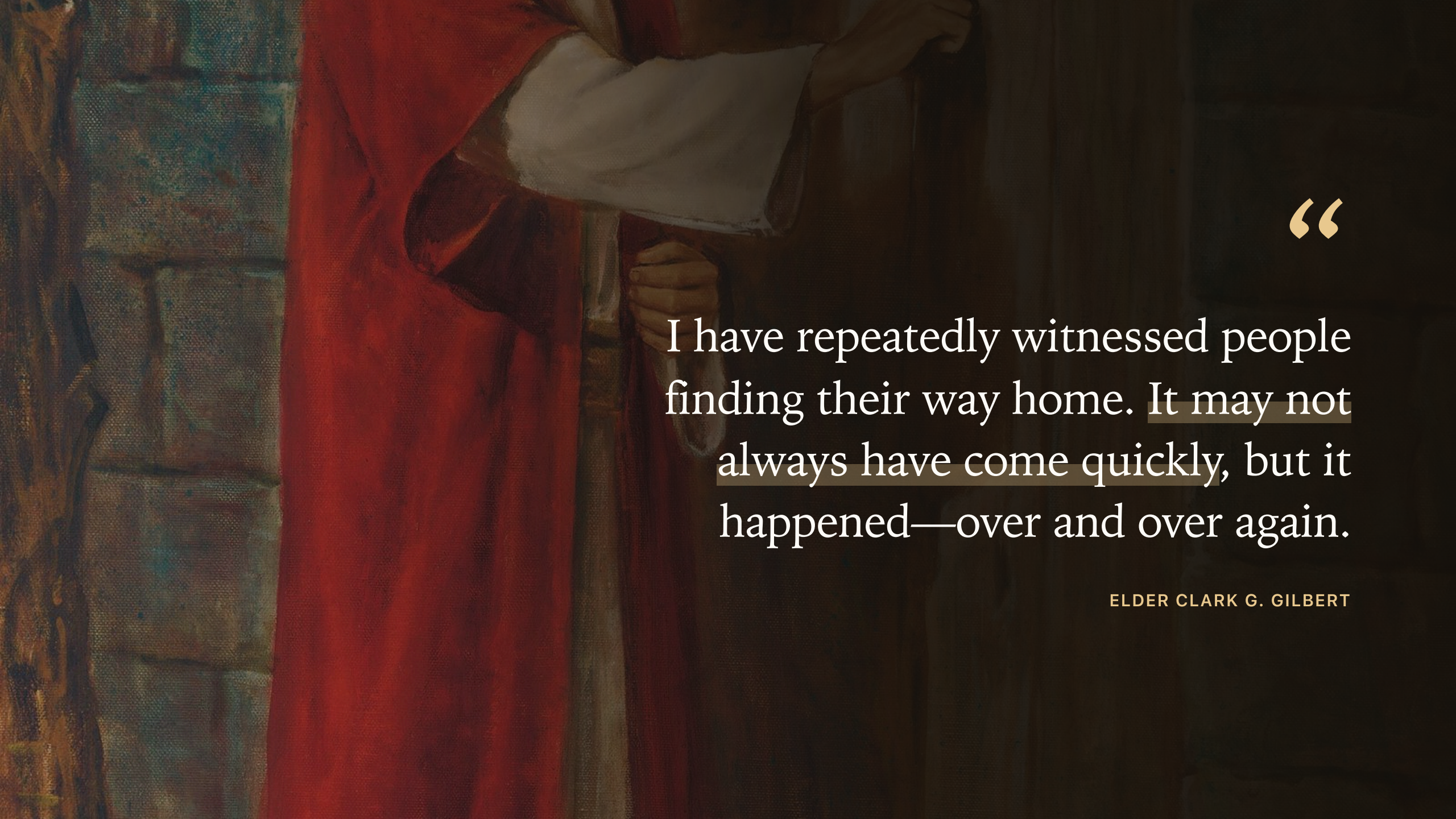
The flow state. Looking back and finally understanding how blessed you were, in every part of your life.

A biblical scene set in a stone archway. In the center, a man with long hair and a beard (Jesus) is embracing a man who is wearing a head covering and a long robe. To the left, a man with a beard and a headband holds a wooden staff. To the right, a woman in a blue and white robe holds a bundle. Other people are visible in the background.

He was accepted before he ever believed.

And through that acceptance he saw two things at once —
that he was loved, and that there was a better way to live.

Patience, service, and love from others — told from the inside, by
someone who came in from the outside.

A painting of a person in a red robe holding a staff, with a stone wall on the left. The person is wearing a white long-sleeved shirt under the red robe. The background is dark and indistinct.

“

I have repeatedly witnessed people finding their way home. It may not always have come quickly, but it happened—over and over again.

ELDER CLARK G. GILBERT

A detailed oil painting of a church congregation in prayer. In the foreground, a woman with dark hair is bowed in prayer, her face partially visible. Behind her, a man with a beard and a woman with glasses are looking upwards with expressions of devotion. Other figures are visible in the background, some with hands raised in prayer. The lighting is soft, creating a solemn and spiritual atmosphere.

04

ELK RIDGE 7TH WARD MISSION PLAN

Bring Them Hither

• Jeff · about 12 minutes

WHERE THE NAME COMES FROM

3 NEPHI 17:7, 9

⁷ Have ye any that are sick among you? Bring them hither. Have ye any that are lame, or blind, or halt, or maimed, or leprous, or that are withered, or that are deaf, or that are afflicted in any manner? Bring them hither and I will heal them, for I have compassion upon you; my bowels are filled with mercy.

⁹ And it came to pass that when he had thus spoken, all the multitude, with one accord, did go forth with their sick and their afflicted, and their lame, and with their blind, and with their dumb, and with all them that were afflicted in any manner; and *he did heal them every one as they were brought forth unto him.*

He did not walk the crowd and find them one by one. He asked the people who already knew where the afflicted were to *bring them*. The healing was always His. The bringing was theirs.



THE INVITATION, IN THREE WORDS

Love • Share • Invite

1 Love.

Build genuine friendships. Minister with Christlike compassion — not as a step toward something else.

2 Share.

Bear testimony of Christ and the restored gospel naturally, in the course of an ordinary conversation.

3 Invite.

Extend simple invitations — to worship, to serve, to follow the Savior.

PILLAR ONE

Home and neighborhood connection

- Visit **every household** inside the ward boundary
- Each visit carries a brief, **non-preachy message** centered on Christ

The goal: neighbors feel surrounded by people who love them — not by recruiters.





PILLAR TWO

Teach the gospel, support the missionaries

- Study and apply **Preach My Gospel** — the second edition is written for *every member*, not just full-time missionaries
- Coordinate with the full-time missionaries: **fed, supported, connected** to the ward
- Spotlight **one ward missionary each month** in the newsletter

PILLAR THREE

The YSA and the rising generation

- A **dedicated ward missionary** assigned to minister to and support the youth
- Casual group activities — pickleball, dinners — as **natural on-ramps**
- **Invite them individually and by name.** Don't assume a YSA will show up to a “family” event
- Give **grandparents and parents of struggling youth** tools and connection



A USEFUL TEST FOR ANY PLAN

Which part of the plan reaches each of Elder Gilbert's four people?

Who feels they don't belong

Who feels they don't measure up

Who doubts

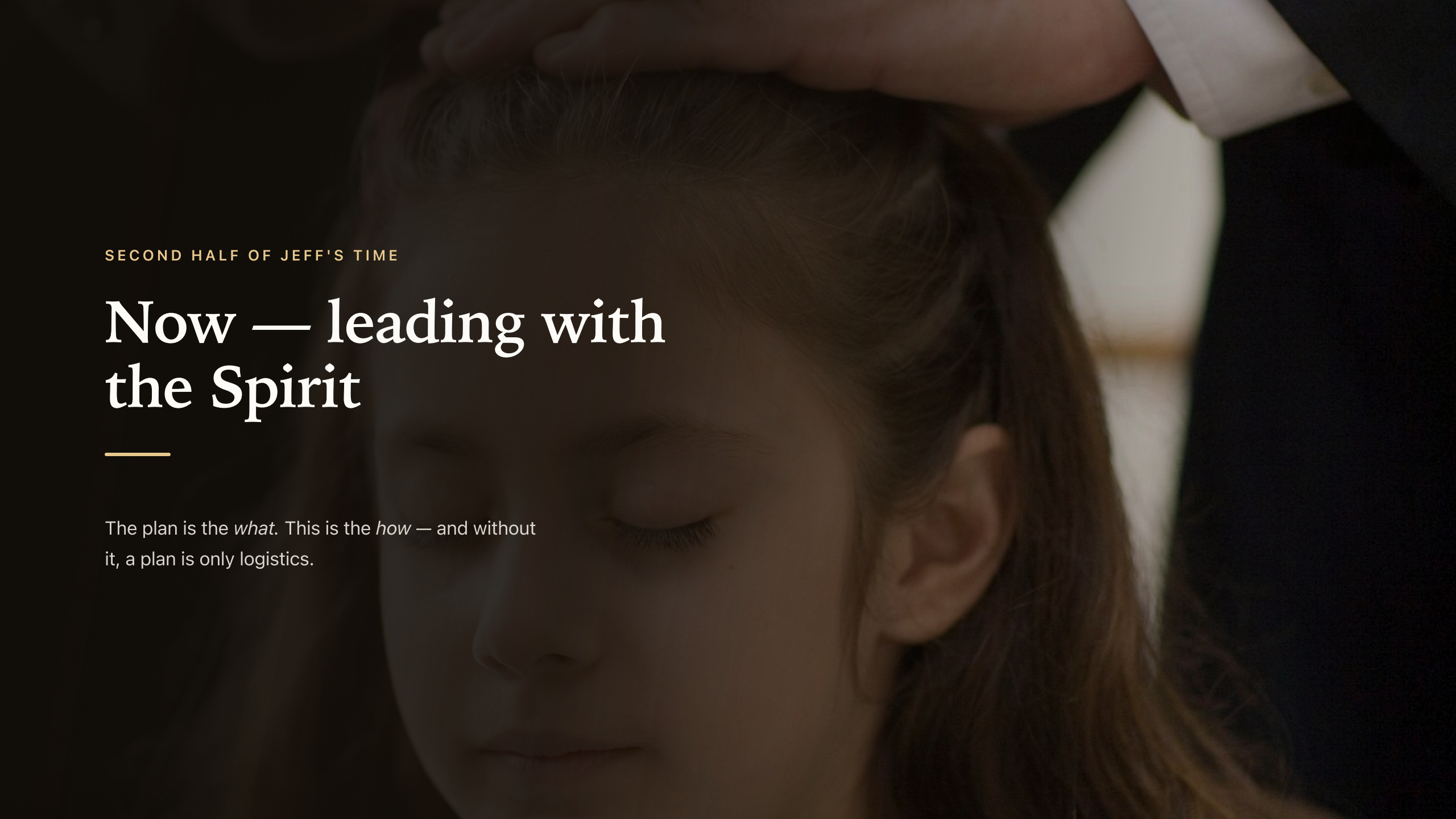
Who is held by tradition

If one of them has no answer in the plan, that's not a failure — it's the most useful thing we could name out loud today.

WHICH IS WHY THE PLAN IS ONLY HALF OF IT

A ward mission plan isn't a sales plan.

It's a plan for creating more moments
where the Spirit can do the teaching.

A close-up, low-key photograph of a young girl with long, light brown hair. Her eyes are closed, and her expression is peaceful. A hand, belonging to an older person in a dark suit and white shirt, is gently resting on top of her head. The lighting is soft and focused on the girl's face, with the background being dark and out of focus.

SECOND HALF OF JEFF'S TIME

Now — leading with the Spirit

The plan is the *what*. This is the *how* — and without it, a plan is only logistics.

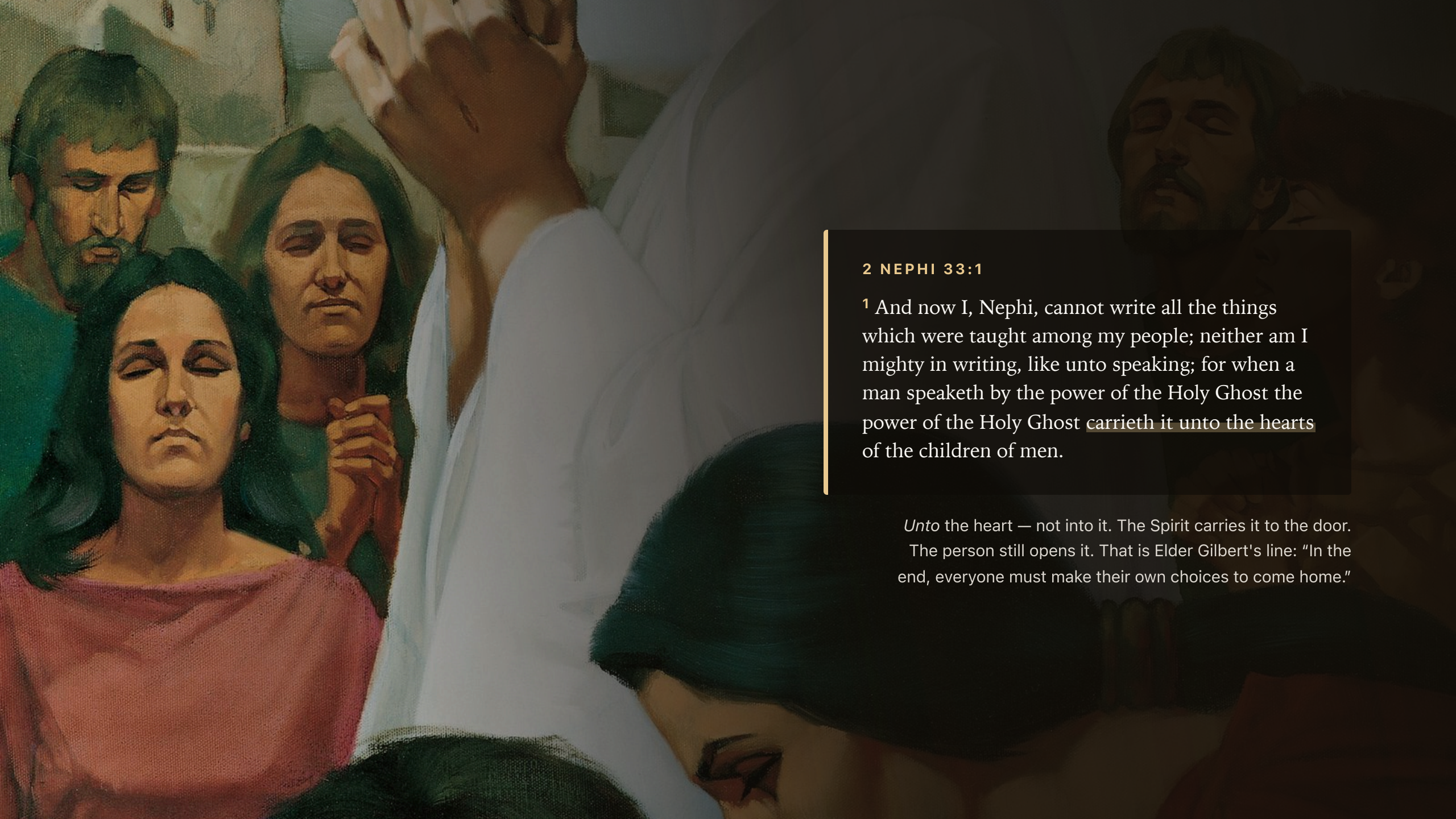
HE ASKS THE QUESTION, THEN ANSWERS IT HIMSELF

DOCTRINE AND COVENANTS 50:13–14

¹³ Wherefore, I the Lord ask you this question — unto what were ye ordained?

¹⁴ To preach my gospel by the Spirit, even the Comforter which was sent forth to teach the truth.

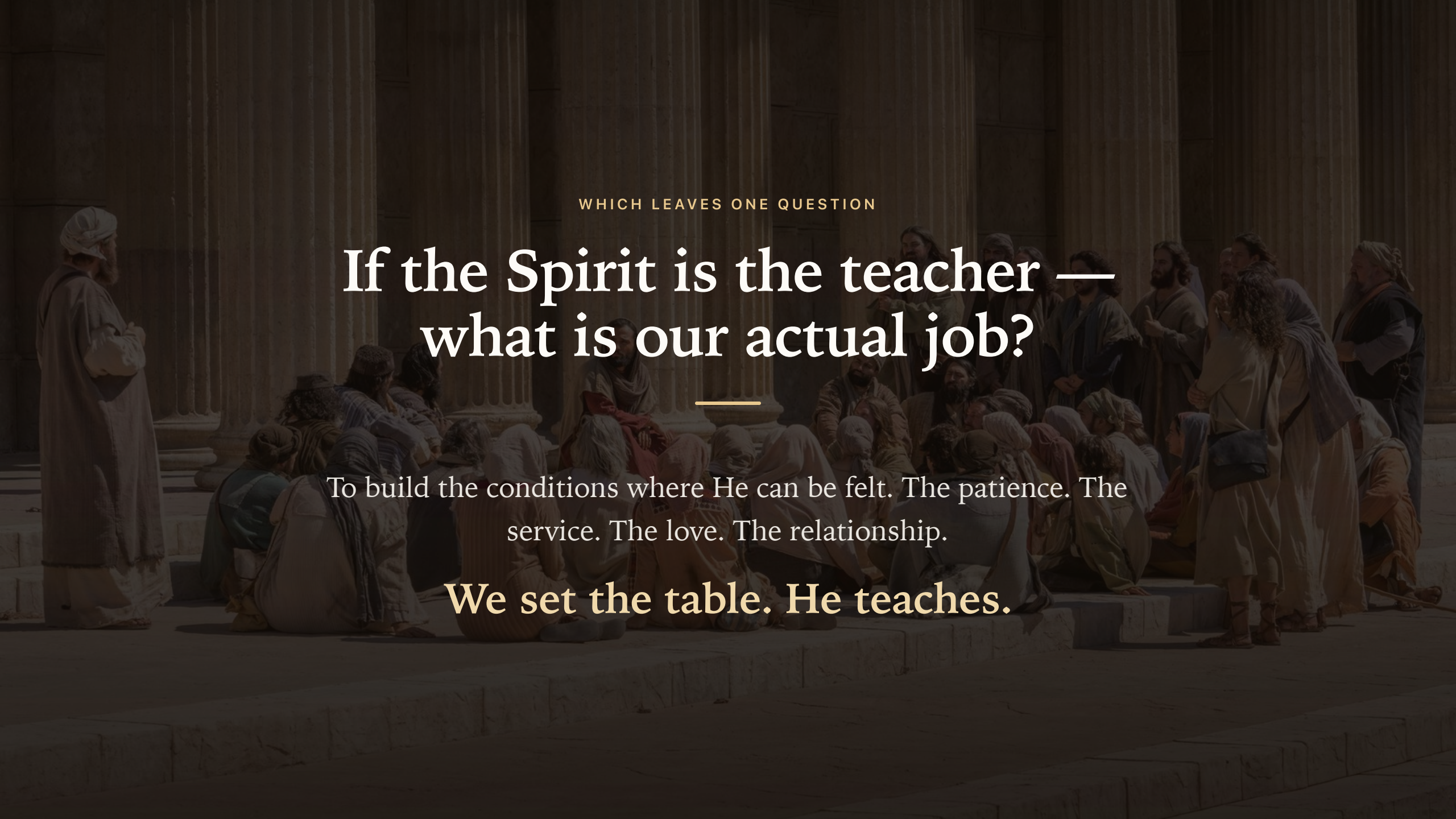
He asks the question and then answers it Himself. We were not ordained to teach the truth. We were ordained to preach by the Spirit — *who* teaches the truth.



2 NEPHI 33:1

¹ And now I, Nephi, cannot write all the things which were taught among my people; neither am I mighty in writing, like unto speaking; for when a man speaketh by the power of the Holy Ghost the power of the Holy Ghost carrieth it unto the hearts of the children of men.

Unto the heart — not into it. The Spirit carries it to the door. The person still opens it. That is Elder Gilbert's line: "In the end, everyone must make their own choices to come home."



WHICH LEAVES ONE QUESTION

If the Spirit is the teacher — what is our actual job?

To build the conditions where He can be felt. The patience. The service. The love. The relationship.

We set the table. He teaches.

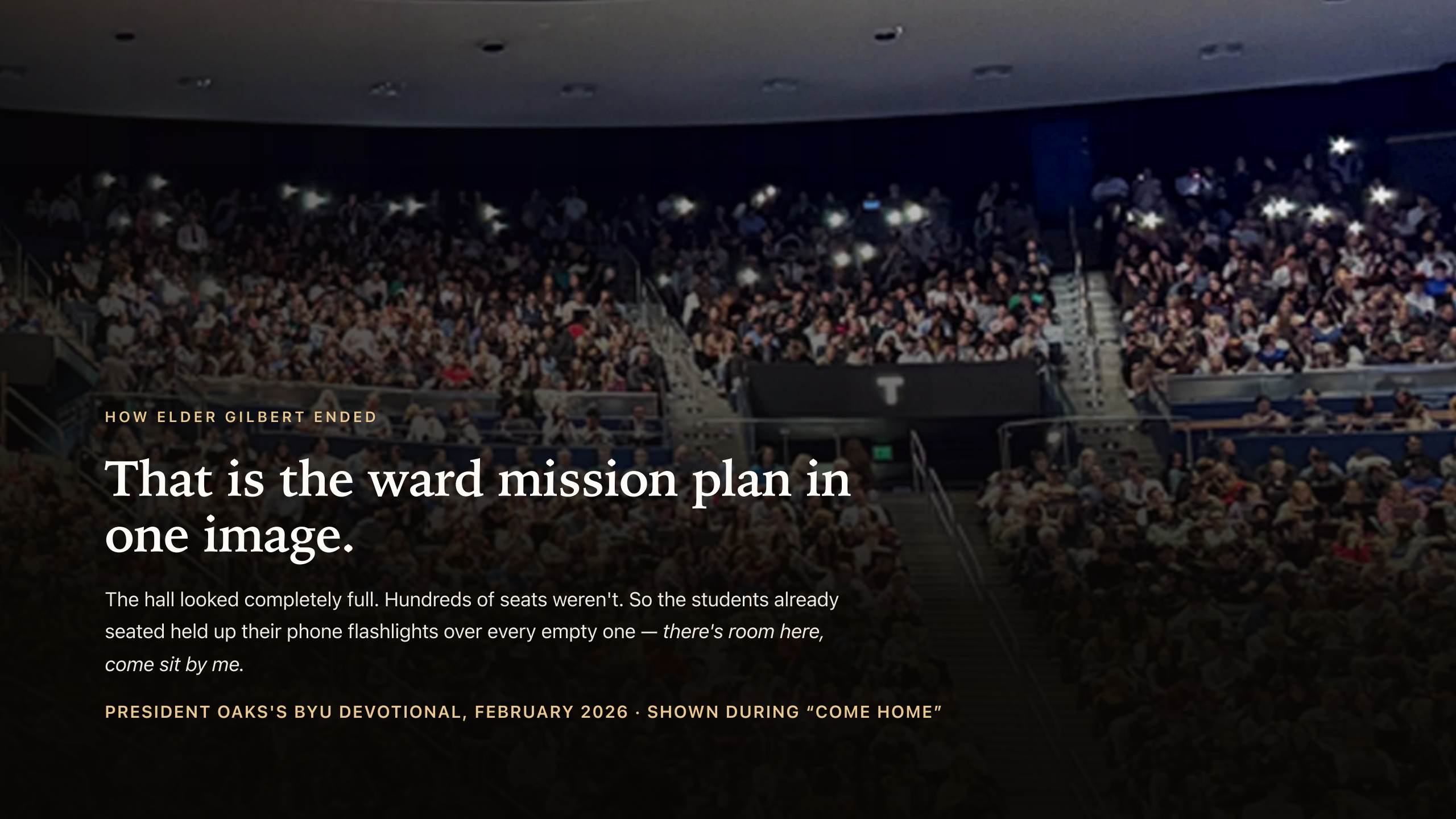
A painting of Jesus with a beard and long hair, wearing a white robe, holding a small white lamb. The background is dark and textured.

BEFORE WE CLOSE

Who have you been thinking
about during this lesson?

You don't have to say the name out loud.

What would showing them more
love look like this week?

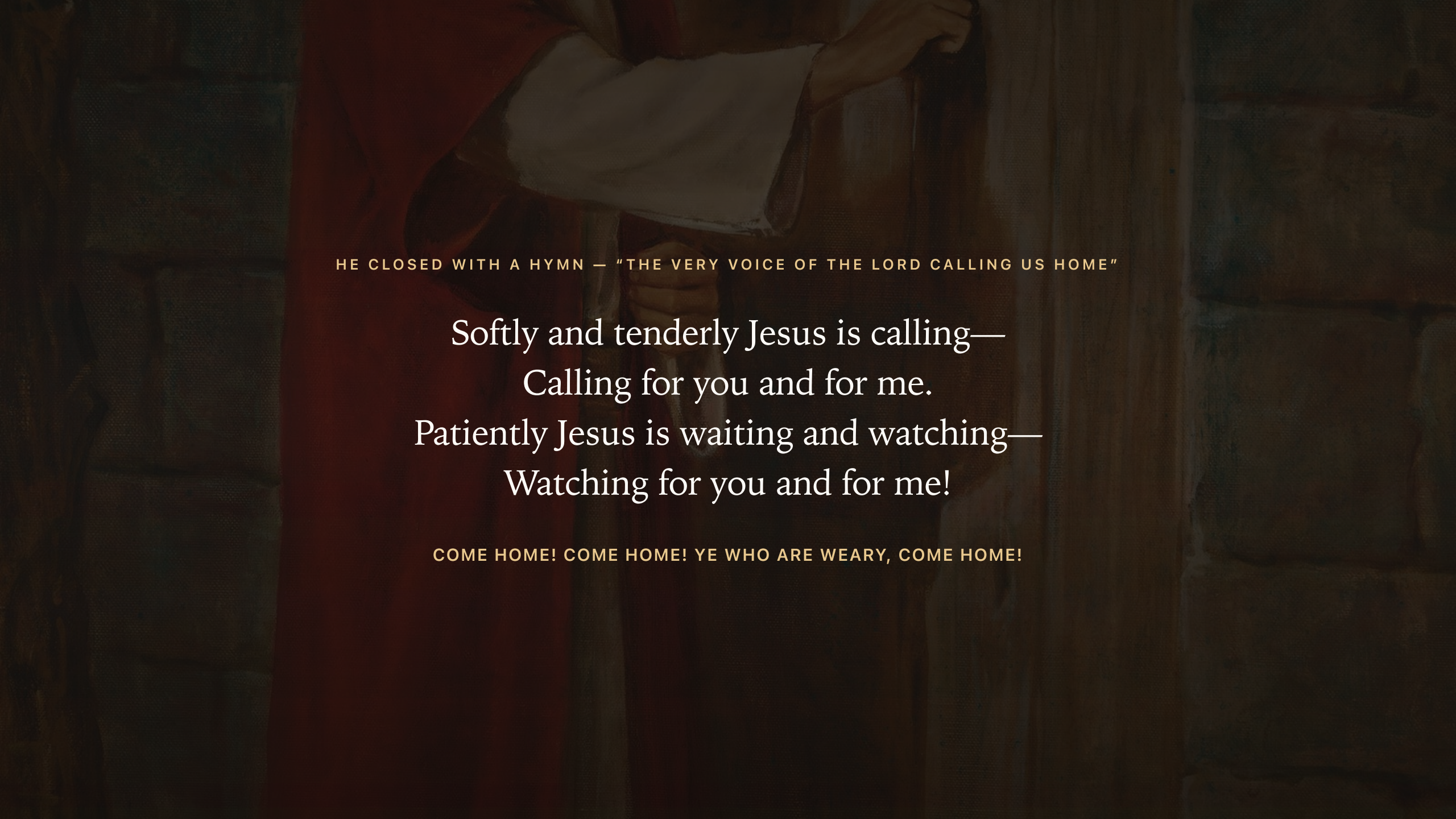


HOW ELDER GILBERT ENDED

That is the ward mission plan in one image.

The hall looked completely full. Hundreds of seats weren't. So the students already seated held up their phone flashlights over every empty one — *there's room here, come sit by me.*

PRESIDENT OAKS'S BYU DEVOTIONAL, FEBRUARY 2026 · SHOWN DURING "COME HOME"



HE CLOSED WITH A HYMN — "THE VERY VOICE OF THE LORD CALLING US HOME"

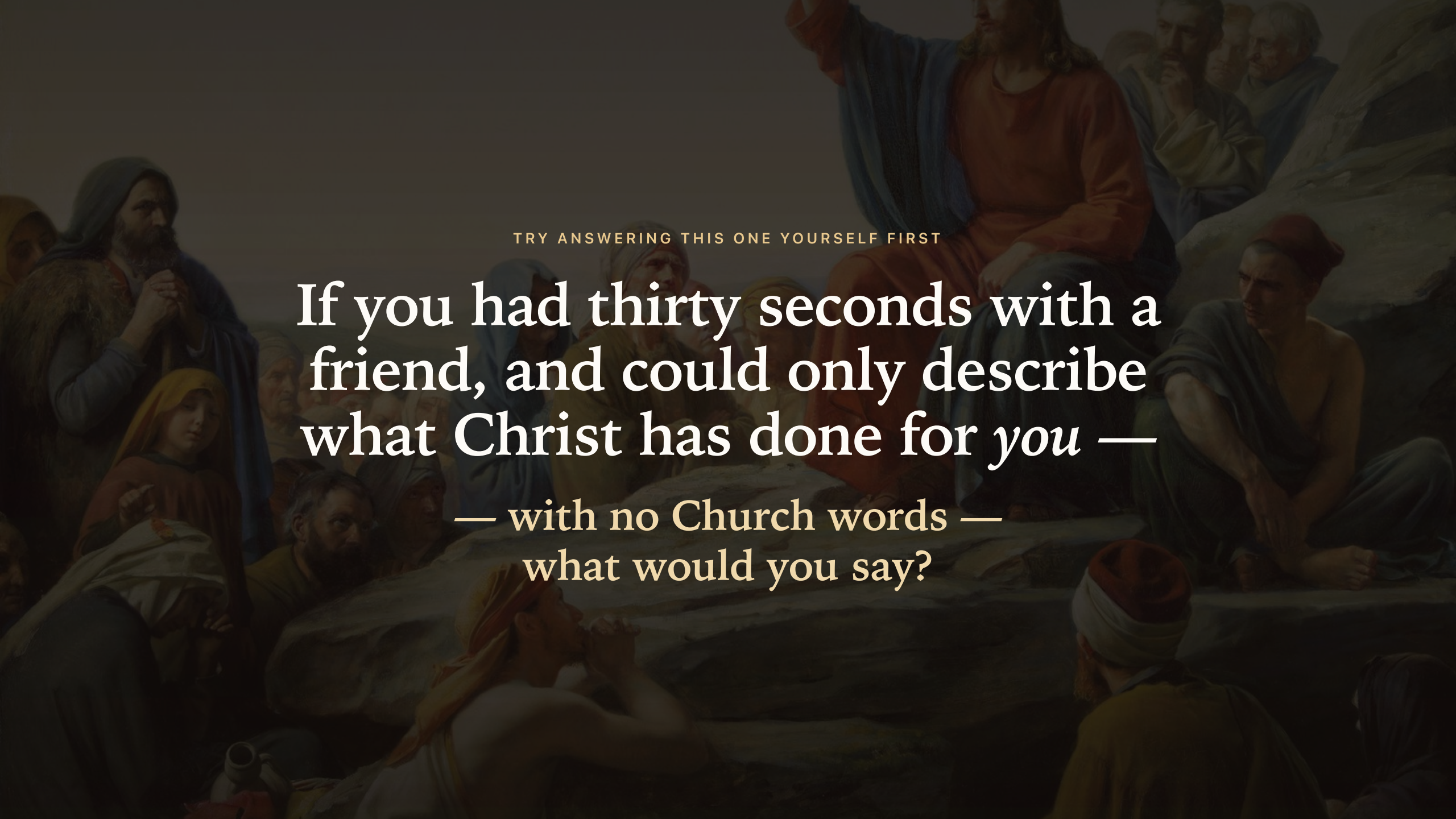
Softly and tenderly Jesus is calling—
Calling for you and for me.
Patiently Jesus is waiting and watching—
Watching for you and for me!

COME HOME! COME HOME! YE WHO ARE WEARY, COME HOME!

WHERE WE STARTED — HEAR IT AGAIN

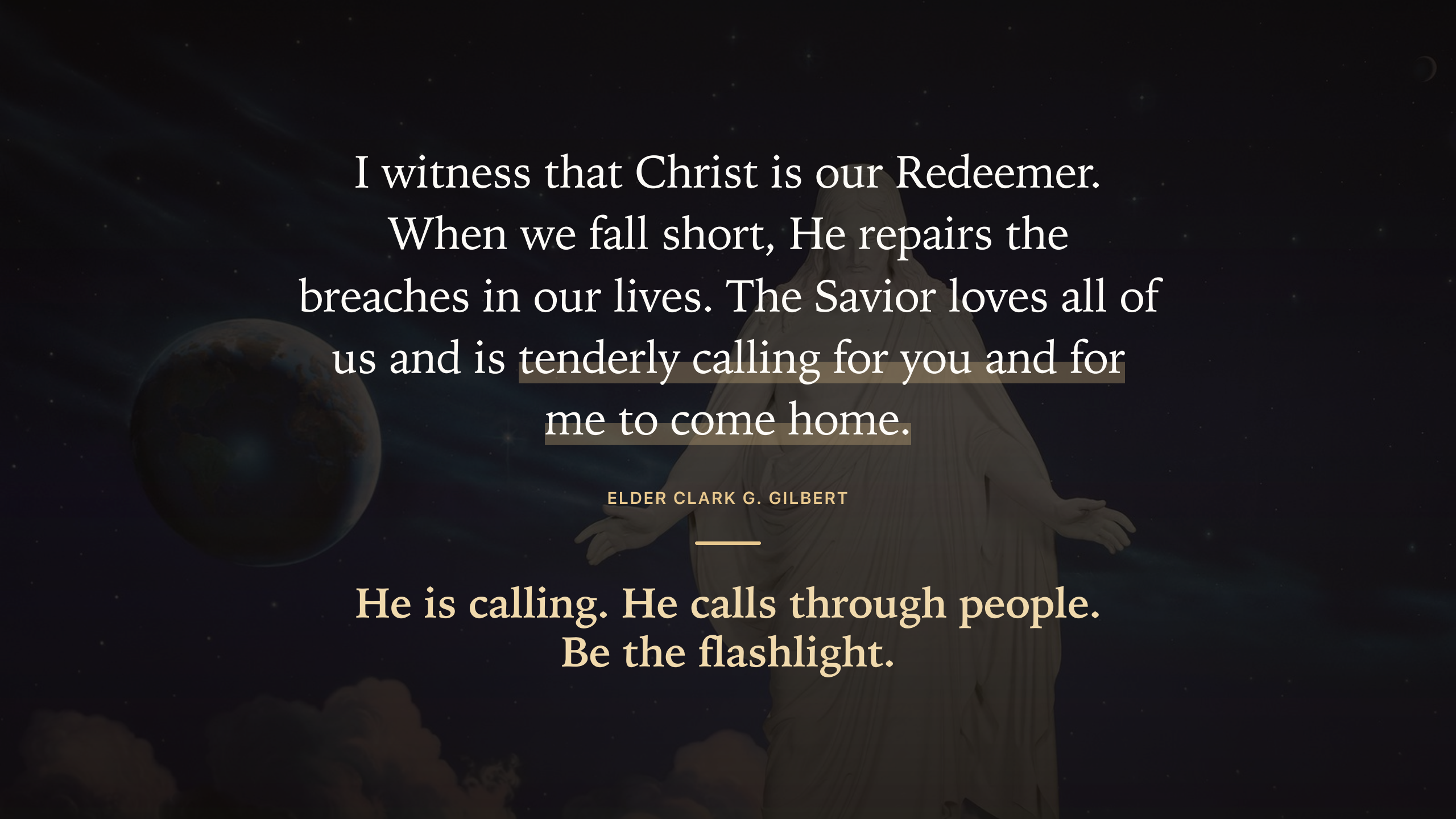
Only Jesus Christ can *fully* restore that light and joy into your life. We all struggle. We need patience, service, and love from others.

ELDER CLARK G. GILBERT

A religious painting depicting Jesus seated on a rock, surrounded by his apostles. Jesus is wearing a red tunic and a blue cloak, with his right hand raised in a gesture of blessing or teaching. The apostles are dressed in various robes and head coverings, some looking towards Jesus with expressions of awe and devotion. The background is a soft, hazy landscape. The overall tone is solemn and reverent.

TRY ANSWERING THIS ONE YOURSELF FIRST

If you had thirty seconds with a
friend, and could only describe
what Christ has done for *you* —
— with no Church words —
what would you say?



I witness that Christ is our Redeemer.
When we fall short, He repairs the
breaches in our lives. The Savior loves all of
us and is tenderly calling for you and for
me to come home.

ELDER CLARK G. GILBERT

He is calling. He calls through people.
Be the flashlight.

HELD IN RESERVE — IF THE DISCUSSION GOES SOMEWHERE ELSE

THE GIFT ITSELF

Isaiah 58:12
Alma 7:11–13
Mosiah 24:14–15
Ether 12:27
Matthew 11:28–30

WHY WE GO

1 Nephi 8:11–12
Alma 26:11–12, 16, 27
Alma 29:1–2, 9
D&C 18:10, 15–16
D&C 88:81

PATIENCE, SERVICE, LOVE

Mosiah 18:8–9
Moroni 7:45–48
Luke 15:4–7, 11–32
John 13:34–35
3 Nephi 18:32

THE SPIRIT TEACHES

D&C 50:13–14, 17–22
2 Nephi 33:1
John 14:26; 16:13
Alma 17:2–3
Moroni 10:4–5; Alma 5:26

SOURCE

Elder Clark G. Gilbert, “Come Home,” April 2026 General Conference, Saturday morning session.
Artwork courtesy of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints Media Library.